

Passport & Travel Documents Checklist

Passport validity rules by country, a renewal decision guide, and everything else identity- and travel-related that your application needs.

Critical passport rule

Most destinations expect your passport to remain valid well beyond your intended stay. Confirm your specific destination's rule before you do anything else - it affects every other date in your timeline.

Passport Validity Requirements by Country

Country	Minimum Validity	Blank Pages	Note
USA	Valid throughout stay	1 blank page	Must be valid for the entire duration of your program
UK	Valid throughout stay	1 blank page	No separate 6-month rule for students
Canada	Valid throughout stay	1 blank page	Plus 1 day beyond your intended stay
Australia	6 months beyond stay	2 blank pages	Pages should be consecutive
Germany	3 months beyond stay	2 blank pages	Schengen visa requirement applies
New Zealand	3 months beyond stay	1 blank page	Passport must be in good physical condition

Renewal Decision Guide

Renew your passport now if any of these apply:

- ☐ Less than 12-18 months of validity remain before your intended program start
- ☐ Fewer blank pages remain than your destination requires
- ☐ The passport is damaged, water-stained, or has loose/torn pages
- ☐ Your name, photo, or biodata page needs updating
- ☐ You anticipate needing it for both your visa AND future travel during your studies

Timing tip

Passport renewal can take several weeks depending on where you apply. Build this into your timeline early - a passport renewal delay can cascade into every other document's timing.

Identity Document Checklist

- ☐ Valid passport with sufficient blank pages for your destination
- ☐ Passport-size photos meeting your destination's exact specifications
- ☐ National ID / citizenship certificate
- ☐ Copies of all previous visas (even expired or refused ones)
- ☐ Birth certificate, where required